



Patent Absurdity available for free download

The new documentary film, "Patent Absurdity: how software patents broke the system", by independent filmmaker Luca Lucarini seeks to expose how judicial activism led to the patenting of software and has broken the US patent system's promise of promoting the progress of science and useful arts. Funded with a grant from the FSF, the film also explores the harm being done to software developers and the wider economy. It is based on a series of interviews conducted during the US Supreme Court's review of "in re Bilski", a case that could have profound implications for the patenting of software. More info and download at: <http://patentabsurdity.com>.



Eben Moglen in *Patent Absurdity*. [Image courtesy: Luca Lucarini. Released under CC-by-sa 3.0 License.]

Perl 5.12 released

Perl 5.12.0, representing approximately two years of development since version 5.10.0, with over 7,500,000 lines of changes, was recently released. Notable changes include:

- Perl now conforms much more closely to the Unicode standard. Additionally, this release includes an upgrade to version 5.2 of the standard.
- New experimental APIs allow developers to extend Perl with 'pluggable' keywords and syntax.
- Perl now has a better sense of time and will be able to keep accurate time well past the 'Y2038' barrier.
- New syntax allows developers to specify package version numbers directly in 'package' statements
- Perl now warns you about the use of deprecated features, by default.

You can find a complete change-list at <http://bit.ly/8YhErK>, and a current list of known issues at <http://bit.ly/af3eak>. More at <http://bit.ly/bliliFy>.

Lightworks video editor to go open source

EditShare plans to release its Lightworks video editor, acquired last September, under an open source licence, in the third quarter of 2010. The company says that this is part of its continued open source strategy, wherein it hopes to attract a developer community that will add new features to the program. Contributed code will be checked by an in-house developer team. They intend to simultaneously set up an online marketplace for developers to sell Lightworks plug-ins.

Lightworks, available since 1989, stands out with its intuitive user interface, real-

time synchronisation and multi-camera editing features. It can also exchange data with other video editors like Avid and Final Cut. Other features include: true shared projects, instant save, multi-cam ingest, 3D editorial functionality, Universal Media File support, native RED editing, native 2K support with DPX and RED, dual outputs, and a format-independent timeline. More at <http://bit.ly/cNAVzP> and <http://bit.ly/9stZFm>.



Supermicro delivers application-optimised servers

Super Micro Computer, Inc. has announced the launch of a complete, optimised selection of servers, workstations and blade solutions that support the new-generation Intel Xeon Processor 5600/3600 Series. With high-efficiency power supplies, advanced cooling sub-systems and server board designs, these offer great performance, density, better performance-per-watt and performance-per-dollar, according to the company.

The TwinBlade platforms are targeted at high-performance computing (HPC), and data centre, enterprise and cloud computing environments. DP platforms based on Intel Xeon 5600 Series processors feature up to 192 GB Reg. ECC DDR3 memory support; a dual Intel 5520/5500 chipset with support for 72 PCI-E 2.0 + 6 PCI-E Lanes; a flexible combination of UIO card support (UIO SAS, 10GbE, 4x 1GbE, QDR and DDR InfiniBand); award-winning SuperBlade & 1U Twin; and 2U Twin2 & 2U Twin with QDR (40 GBps) and DDR (20 GBps) InfiniBand designs; onboard IPMI 2.0 plus KVM with dedicated LAN support and onboard SAS 2.0 (6 GBps) controller with RAID 0, 1, 5 and 10 support.

UP platforms based on Intel Xeon 3600 Series processors feature up to 24 GB of unbuffered DDR3 memory support (ECC/non-ECC); Intel X58 chipset support for up to 40 PCI-E 2.0 lanes for IO expansion; onboard IPMI 2.0 plus KVM over dedicated LAN and onboard SAS/SATA controller with RAID 0, 1, 5 and 10 support.